

QUADRAM INSTITUTE WEBSITE 2027

PROJECT REQUIREMENTS

Our current website was designed nearly 10 years ago and has performed a sterling job for us over the intervening years.

But it is time for a new website that better reflects our users' needs. We want a website that reflects our brand, tells people about the impact our science makes, and is more accessible, responsive, and faster to load (especially on mobile).

To do this, we need a team to help us. Attached is all the information you need to bid for this project. To be in with a chance of becoming the team that builds our site, all you need to do is to tell us how you'd be able to help us achieve this by 28 April 2027.

Introduction

This document provides the necessary information for web design agencies, to bid to build, user-test and maintain a website for us – www.quadram.ac.uk

Tender return date: 21 September 2026

About the Quadram Institute

Our institute is home to world-leading researchers making discoveries in the gut microbiome, food and health, alongside the region's Endoscopy unit which provides outstanding NHS clinical care.

Our mission is to understand how food and the gut microbiota are linked to the promotion of health, with an emphasis on diet- and age-associated diseases. We use this knowledge to develop evidence-based strategies to maximise positive impacts of food on health, from early life to the extension of a healthy lifespan in old age and reduce the economic and societal costs of chronic diseases.

The website should reflect our values:

- **People-Centred Impact**
We measure success by healthier lives and empowered communities, ensuring our research delivers tangible benefits.
- **Inclusive Excellence**
Diversity fuels discovery. We cultivate an environment where every voice is heard, every talent is nurtured, and respect is non-negotiable.

- **Trusted Integrity**
Rigour, transparency, and ethics underpin our work, earning the confidence of patients, partners, and the public.
- **Collaborative Spirit**
Breakthroughs happen together. We partner openly across disciplines, sectors, and borders to turn knowledge into real-world solutions.
- **Agile Innovation**
We stay curious and responsive, adapting rapidly to emerging challenges while stewarding resources responsibly for future generations.

About our website

Our website now receives over 525k views from over 200k users a year and provides a window to the world for our science and our researchers. It's where we want to show the impact of the work we do.

Our website also helps us recruit members of the public to clinical trials, provides information for NHS patients having endoscopy procedures, and hosts nutritional data and tools for the food industry.

We want the website to:

- Communicate the impact of our science and the relationships between our science, our people, and our research partners
- We want our website to maximise Search Engine Optimisation (SEO) and Generative Engine Optimisation (GEO)
- Help engage the public with the impact of our science and use the website to help recruit members of the public to our clinical trials
- Provide access to key resources and datasets such as the Composition of Foods Integrated Datasets e.g. <https://fnnbri.quadram.ac.uk/developer-tools/>
- Help attract funding, industry and scientific collaborations
- Help attract the brightest and best researchers and science support staff

Audiences

Our website helps serve a diverse range of audiences:

- The general public interested in our research and services;
 - with a bias towards people adults living in Norfolk and Suffolk interested in taking part in our research studies
 - NHS patients using the Quadram Institute endoscopy unit
- Academic communities nationally and internationally
- Funders such as research councils, government departments and charities
- Politicians, civil servants and journalists/key opinion-formers
- Food and health industry

User experience and journeys

User experience and user journeys are not just design considerations for us but core deliverables. We believe in using data to make informed decisions. As such, we will require the site to undergo rigorous user testing through the development to ensure our website meets the needs of its users. Testing should include:

- Functional testing
- User acceptance testing
- Browser compatibility testing (Chrome, Safari, Edge, Firefox)
- Mobile testing
- Security testing

The new website must:

- Enable users to complete their primary tasks quickly and efficiently
- Improve engagement, conversion, and customer satisfaction
- Meet accessibility standards (WCAG 2.2 AA as a minimum)
- Provide a consistent experience across desktop, tablet, and mobile devices

User Research

The supplier should:

- Review existing user data and analytics
- Conduct stakeholder and user research where appropriate
- Identify key user personas
- Present findings and recommendations

Essential functionality requirements and key information

- Our preference is for the site to be built using WordPress
- It will be hosted on our servers which are managed by the NBI Computing team – see “Computing Hosting Policy”.
- We set high standards (AA as minimum) for accessibility and have a legal duty under the Equality Act to ensure accessibility
- It must pass Google Core Web Vitals

Given the above, we will need to include the following **essential functionality in the site**

- Publications - XML plug-in/feed from our inhouse “NBIROS” scientific publications system
- Job vacancy listings – managed by our HR team
- Staff directory – including pages for all staff and students.
- Contact us form
- News and Blogs - Multiple types of content with easy-to-use editors
 - Page layouts for press release, news, events and blogs (taggable by subject)
 - Page layouts/template for human study recruitment
 - Event listings (no ticketing requirements)
- Google analytics
- Internal site search
- Responsive mobile first design
- Friendly URLs and redirects
- Ability to embed external items (i.e. Find a PhD, and YouTube) into pages
- Automated breadcrumbs
- Generate XML site map for Google Search Console
- Editable metadata - for at least the page descriptions and images
- Page load speeds of under 2.5 seconds

Branding and design

The design of the website needs to be in line with our [existing branding](#). We are willing to take advice and suggestions on how we could improve the accessibility and functionality of the site.

Maintenance, training and support

As part of the contract we require virtual/online CMS training for five staff.

Following the build of the website we would also be looking for the developer to provide;

- A 12-month maintenance package for troubleshooting post launch.
- An ongoing support and maintenance package beyond 12-months (at least to five years from launch).

Copyright

Ownership of assets including the content and imagery is in sole ownership of Quadram Institute Bioscience.

Hosting and Domain Requirements

- We require the website to be hosted in-house, managed by the NBI Computing team, please see NBIP Computing Hosting Policy.
- The WordPress CMS system will be required to be accessed remotely, via our existing VPN connection process via open access software
- We would require the site's applications, components and software to be thoroughly tested throughout the build, with the expectation that this site will be maintained and supported throughout the lifetime of the site (>5 years).
- Any forms or areas where collection of personal data is involved, must be compliant with GDPR.
- The website should provide a cookie consent mechanism, and users should be able to view the Privacy Policy from every page.
- The website domain will remain quadram.ac.uk

Security requirements

We need the website to be designed and operated in accordance with recognised security best practices, including:

- HTTPS encryption
- role-based access control
- secure authentication using SSO (NBI Computing)
- vulnerability management
- regular backup and recovery
- security monitoring
- compliance with UK GDPR requirements.

Content Migration

The website has a large number of pages (c. 3,000), with news and other key information dating back many years. Many of these pages and news items will need to be migrated to the new site. Your tender should include a plan for how this is to be managed and achieved in the timeframe.

Timescales

We would like the site to go live on **28 April 2027**.

The proposed timescale (indicative dates, subject to change) is;

- 21 September 2026 - tenders received by email to info@quadram.ac.uk
- w/c 28 September - shortlisted candidates are contacted
- w/c 5 October - in person or virtual presentations and interviews for shortlisted candidates
- w/c 12 October – tender awarded
- 19 October – project begins
- 31 March 2027 - site signed off and available internally for checking and content updates
- **28 April 2027** - site fully live

Budget

The budget for this project is £50k inc. of VAT and all costs. As a general guide, your tender should cover all management, operation and associated costs, including VAT. As well as the total cost, a simple breakdown of how you have arrived at your price for the commission would be helpful.

Format of responses required

We are happy to accept tenders by email to info@quadram.ac.uk. The tender proposals should include:

- An outline of the approach that will be taken to establishing and delivering the project
- Detailed costs/budget breakdown
- A timetable for the project
- Any previous experience and range of work you think is relevant

Evaluation criteria

The tenders will be evaluated by the Head of External Relations and Engagement (Andrew Stronach), Communications Manager (Andrew Chapple), Digital Campaigns Manager (Ruby O’Grady), and a representative from the NBI Partnership Computing team.

Each proposal will be evaluated against the following criteria:

Criteria	Weighting
Understanding of, and responsive fit with our project brief	40%
Credibility and proven expertise in user-focused website design and development	30%
Proposed team and resources within the set budget for the project	25%
Any added value offered by the tenderer	5%

We reserve the right not to award a contract if it is judged that no viable or appropriate tender has been received. For full terms and conditions please see the accompanying document “Terms and Conditions for Goods and Services.”

The successful tenderer will be expected to sign a contract based on our terms and conditions for purchasing services. Tenderers should indicate in their response that they will be willing to accept these terms and conditions (included in appendices).

Contact

- Andrew Stronach – Head of External Relations and Engagement, Quadram Institute, Rosalind Franklin Road, Norwich Research Park, NR4 7UQ
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